

Interviewer: Okay, alright, so, let me formally start. I have my script so I just start with of course thanking you for participating in this interview, and as mentioned over the email, we want to know more about your views on romantic relationships and we believe your experience and perspective would bring much to the project. So we're now recording it and we will only use it for transcription and note-taking. Right, so, I will start with some, there are several portions in the interview so the first part is on demographics. I've already asked this via email but for recording purposes, I'll be asking some of the questions again. So how old are you?

Speaker: I'm [30-35] years old po.

Interviewer: Right. And how long have you been together with your partner?

Speaker: For [6-10] years.

Interviewer: [11-15].

Speaker: [6-10].

Interviewer: Sorry, [6-10] years. Sorry, my mistake. All right, and just to record whether you have children or not?

Interviewer: None.

Speaker: None.

Interviewer: And do you live together in the same household?

Speaker: Yes

Interviewer: Yes. And who lives in the household, aside from the two of you?

Speaker: My side of the family.

Interviewer: All right. So can you give me just a number, a rough estimate if the more permanent members in the household?

Speaker: There's [6-10] of us. My mom, my dad, and my [1-5] siblings, and the both of us.

Interviewer: All right. Thank you. Can be very general but what is your main source of income? You personally?

Speaker: Me personally, work and I have some [occupation] on the side.

Interviewer: If you can classify your work, it can be general as well. Or would you classify this in [field]?

Speaker: In service

Interviewer: [Field]?

Speaker: Oh no, [Field].

Interviewer: [Field], sorry, [Field]. All right. Thank you. Since we will be addressing your partner from time to time, how would you want me to address your partner? So that when I refer to him, would you rather, I refer to him by, you know, it can be very generic like partner or husband.

Speaker: Husband.

Interviewer: So, thank you for that. So, we're done with the demographics. So, we will move on to some general context about your relationship. So, this is more like the love story. Just to set a context to this interview on relationship. So, can you tell me general idea about your love story?

Speaker: Oh, our love story was actually, I met him in my first job. I applied at that time. We were both in the [industry]. He was ahead of me. So, on my, I think, [1st-5th] month in the company, we didn't still have a branch for that, for the bank here in [City A]. So what we did, ay, what our boss did was to send us to another branch to learn the ropes in the [industry]. So after that, I think it was after [1-5] months when our branch was finally finished because they had some renovations for the rented area. And that's how I met him. We worked together. He was the one who trained me and we got to know each other and he asked me out. After that, we're here now, [6-10] years later.

Interviewer: Right, so since you're referring to him as your husband, you got married at what time?

Speaker: During the pandemic.

Interviewer: So that's around [Year]?

Speaker: [Year].

Interviewer: At [Year], okay. So if you were to describe a bit about your love story, how would you assess how the relationship developed? How would you describe the development of your relationship? So you met in your job, you worked together. So was this based on, how would you assess it? Was it based on, like, some people, you know, it's love at first sight, some would start with friendship, you know. How would you describe it as far as your love story is concerned?

Speaker: Oh, okay. For me, it was friendship at first, but he already made his intentions after probably a month of getting to know each other. Then that's how it happened for me. And I guess during those times, I wasn't really looking for a relationship. But, things happened. I got to like him a lot and then eventually, we became a couple. But at first, it was friendship at first.

Interviewer: Okay. Alright. So thank you. Yeah, thank you for that. So now we're, I will be asking you questions about relationship quality, right? So how would you, the assumption of this question is you know friends who have relationships as well, right? So romantic in that sense, romantic relationships. So, how would you compare the quality of your relationship with your husband compared to that of your friends' relationships? So, how would you compare it?

Speaker: For me, now my friends, most of my friends already have children. So for us being a married couple without children, it's quite different as compared to theirs, where there's, their main focus now is usually their children. And for us, we're just together a young couple. So, I think we're still on the romantic part of the marriage as compared to some of our friends who already have children where they're all, both of the couple, are focused on the children. But they're still, they share that there are still some romantic activities or they go on dates from time to time but not as often as how we go on dates as compared to them.

Interviewer: Right. So if I'm getting this correctly, in terms of a general comparison, not having a child or children, not having children makes that quite different from other relationships, from the relationships

of your friends. But, if I may just probe a little, if you were to compare, let's say in terms of quality, like the way you define quality, we will not impose any kind of definition. But in terms of the quality of your relationship, how would you compare it to the quality of your friends' relationships who have children, for instance?

Speaker: Okay. So probably I would compare the quality in terms of doing some romantic activities or being emotionally available for each other. So if you're on a higher level as compared to our friends who have children already. Although I can't see how they still love each other, but now that they have children, it's more of like, it's kind of, I don't know, it's different.

Interviewer: Yeah, yeah.

Speaker: How we are, just a couple and no children yet. Although, of course, we're still planning to have children, but in terms of a romantic level, it's quite different. Like being emotionally available to each other as compared when they have children.

Interviewer: All right. So, when you say emotionally available, has this something to do with, what would be the indicators of, let's say, a relationship that manifests emotional availability?

Speaker: Yeah. When I say emotionally available, in terms of, like, when we get to go on dates or even just hanging out in the house, having conversations, we open up with each other's feelings or what happened to your day and then share stories to each other in a way that I can tell him that I'm frustrated, I'm mad, I'm sad, something like that. And sometimes he can do the same. But it's more me opening up to him. So we're like open to communication. So the emotions like I give out, my frustrations, he's there available to comfort me or if not to encourage me and I do the same for him as compared with some of our friends who share like their issues, not really on their marriage, but more on issues in their household and they share it more to us. I mean to the girlfriends or to the, oh, I'm sorry, to the friends rather than the husband or if they share stories with me, it's more on their frustrations to their husbands.

Interviewer: Yes. All right. Yeah, I understand already. So, by the way you gave an example, by the way you gave examples and you qualified what you meant by emotionally available. I think as far as I'm concerned, it's quite clearer now how you would, like for example, when you say that there's a difference between the relationship quality of your friends relative to your relationship.

Speaker: Yeah, right.

Interviewer: Okay, so thank you for that. Now, if you don't mind me asking, I'd like to ask if you had any romantic partners in the past?

Speaker: Yes po.

Interviewer: You've had, and is it okay to ask how many yung official or romantic partners?

Speaker: I had two.

Interviewer: [1-5], all right. Okay. And now, so we're still in relationship quality. So this time, kanina kasi we tried to compare your relationship with your husband to that of the relationship of your friends. Now this time, given that you've had [1-5] other partners in the past, romantic partners in the past, how would you compare the quality of your relationship now compared to those previous relationships?

Speaker: Hmm. The previous relationships, I had them when I was still a student. But they were more of, like, not that serious as compared to his where I just thought of the typical “my boyfriend”, having a boyfriend, something like that, going into this cute relationship but never really thinking of turning it into marriage or something that's forever.

Interviewer: So it's more...

Speaker: Temporary.

Interviewer: Sorry, sorry.

So it's more, sorry, sorry.

Speaker: Temporary.

Interviewer: Temporary.

Interviewer: Okay. So, um, so would you say that in terms of relationship quality, this might sound leading but you can correct me if I'm wrong. So if you're saying that the previous relationships are not serious, you know, I think you, you mentioned the term it's cute or temporary. Are you therefore saying that somehow this current relationship is better than the previous romantic partners?

Speaker: Yes, po. Kasi, like my previous relationship, they were more like the same as my age as compared to what I have now. He's older than me for [1-5] years. So I appreciated the maturity.

Interviewer: Right. Okay. So, the maturity is there.

Interviewer: Okay. So, thank you for that. So, um, this is a more general question but still on relationship quality. For you, what makes a relationship high quality, and what makes a relationship low quality? So, uh, more of comparing the two. So to say that one is high quality relationship versus low quality.

Speaker: For me, high quality is like what I've mentioned about being emotionally available for each other, where you can support each other and, um, being an encouragement to each other. And something that's more of a partnership rather than something that, something that is casual, which I would call for low quality na it's something casual. It's something, for the low quality, besides being it casual, it's being also absent emotionally as well. Being absent emotionally and probably in terms of communication as well. I see that low-quality relationships have less communication.

Interviewer: Yes. Right. Okay. Right.

So, um, okay. I think I was able to take down those notes. For high quality, emotionally available. So these are the keywords, there's support and encouragement and there's more of partnership. As for the low quality, uh, you, uh, your descriptions where it's more casual and there's also again, in relation to being, kumbaga, yung isa is emotionally available. This one is emotionally absent and you gave emphasis on the importance of communication. Or in low quality relationship would have a lesser, lesser, I suppose, degree or frequency of communication.

Speaker: Yeah.

Interviewer: Is that it? When it comes to communication, is it in the frequency or it's in the?

Speaker: In terms of communication, I would say how deep it is or how not really how frequent, more on how deep the conversation is. Because, they can ask each other kung kumain ka na?

Interviewer: Yeah, yeah.

Speaker: Oo.

Interviewer: So, parang kumbaga mas, uh, like the examples you gave earlier, like, you know, when you want to, uh, uh, share your frustrations or something like that, are those the kinds of uh.

Speaker: Yeah, something like that. And something that's, I mean, what I see in our relationship, we talk about a lot of things that piques our interests. Unlike for those with low quality, they just talk about, I don't know, like the casual things or I've seen them talk about just what's trending, something like that.

Interviewer: Uh huh, okay.

Speaker: Really, not everyone's, it's not really your interest or the person's interests. It's just something in, in general or chismis in other level.

Interviewer: Okay. All right. Sige. So na-capture ko naman ata iyon. All right. So thank you for that.

So, um, the next question on relationship quality still. For you, what are the most important things in a relationship? Ayan, what are the most important things in a relationship?

Speaker: Um, for.

Interviewer: You have mentioned some of this, by the way, no? Of course, like halimbawa, you mentioned something on being emotionally available, the importance of communication, support, encouragement. But, um, but if you were, let's say to, you know, somehow rank the most important things in a relationship, which would this be kaya?

Speaker: For me, it's actually number one is communication.

Interviewer: Okay.

Speaker: Or I would say the partnership. So in molding the partnership, you must have good communication. Kasi, I understand and I've already internalized this that in a relationship, not everything is always physical where you get to have that. I mean, for other there, for other people, they have their love language is touch, which is I understand. As you go older, you won't have the energy and putting into something physical or into some touching. So for me, communication is my top thing in a relationship.

Speaker: And next is, of course, loyalty. If you're loyal to each other, then that's good. And then I think now a lot of relationships are going for open relationships, which I think is ridiculous. So loyalty for me, especially during this time is very important. And then, yeah, that's probably it. And probably, like I said, the support towards each other, the encouragement that the both gives. But in general, I mean, for me as a Christian, of course, there's God who takes it all together and bundles it up.

Interviewer: Okay, right. So, you mentioned like four. So, top of the list is good communication. And this is the key to honing the partnership between the couple. And then you also mentioned loyalty. Third is support and encouragement. And fourth is, as based on your, as you mentioned, based on your Christian faith, that God is part of the picture of a relationship.

Speaker: Actually, I'll put the fourth one on top.

Interviewer: All right, okay.

Speaker: Kasi, what I believe is if he doesn't fear God.

Interviewer: Right

Speaker: Wala siyang takot, gagawin nya kung anong gusto niya.

Interviewer: Hmm. Okay, so let me correct that. So, this should be the top and then the other indicators or the other criteria would come after.

Speaker: Right

Interviewer: Okay. Now, a little bit of conceptualization, para 'tong slambook. So for you, what is love? Ayan, if you were to define love, what is love?

Speaker: If you say love po kasi, there's always this, in the Christian faith. There's the sacrificial love, which I believe Jesus did for us, which is something incredible. And I think since that is what Jesus did for us or for us as the church, I think love is also sacrificial in terms of marriage. Sacrificial also in a sense that of course, I will die for you, something like that, or most likely a sacrificial love in a sense where you have sacrificed the things that you want in life for you to have this relationship with somebody that is even more than what you think you want. So, sacrificing the, even the opportunities, your time for yourself, sacrificing your friends even. Like throwing away your old life and just sacrificing it all just for this person. So I think that love is something really sacrificial. You have to give up a lot if you feel or if you think that this love is worth to be defending.

Interviewer: All right, thank you. So thank you for that definition of love.

So the keyword of course, as you reiterated, is the importance of really internalizing the concept of sacrificial love. Now, given this definition of love, how important is love in a relationship? How important is love in a relationship?

Speaker: Love is of course very important at top for me. Love is so important where it doesn't even mean you have to be always romantic towards each other. Kasi, if you love the person, yeah if you love the person, the four things that I've mentioned, actually the three things, if you love God, and you love the person, the three things would follow like the communication, loyalty, and the support and encouragement towards each other.

Interviewer: So kumbaga, it's a key element in a relationship. And as you said, that love is of course not just for the other person, but you also mentioned something, of course, earlier you mentioned something about sacrificial love as the one that, okay, thank you for that.

So, as a follow-up question to this, given that love is indeed important and based on that definition of sacrificial love for example, how do you know that your partner loves you?

Speaker: How I identify or how I recognize his love is, of course, usually in the small things, so being it sacrificial, He, I can see it towards his actions and of course him saying it to me, but I appreciate it more when I see it through his actions. So, it's more on the little things, the little things that he does where

knowing him, his background. He is, being the only child as well, he experienced having it all, so, everything was given to him, not literally given to him, but he doesn't have to share.

Interviewer: Oo, kasi nga solo, solo na anak.

Speaker: So, I've seen him do things that he doesn't usually do. So, one of that is sharing, sharing everything with me, and even sharing almost everything also with my family, especially in our Filipino culture once you marry a Filipina, you marry the family. So, I've seen that from him and those are my indicators of how he shows me that he loves me. So uh 'yon, that's it po.

Interviewer: All right, sige. Thank you for that. Now, of course, love is not always perfect. So, I have here some questions on challenges or conflicts in relationships. So, what would you say are the challenges in your relationship?

Speaker: So the challenges po in our relationship. Actually, what are the challenges?

Interviewer: Or anything that maybe you've argued about or fought about perhaps, or if not at that level, anything that maybe have created some kind of, hindi naman necessary between the two of you, but, you know, things that your relationship faces as a challenge or conflicts ganyan. It could be conflicts or challenges in general.

Speaker: Oh. To be honest, we never had a real big fight. Siguro po may mga tampuhan, pero it would last for max is a week. Actually, sometimes it won't go on for a week, just probably three days, but your challenge probably would be, kasi him being in [Company], or my culture being an [Ethnicity], he can really understand a lot of our culture.

Speaker: And, uh, challenge. More on...I can't think of any...

Interviewer: It's okay.

Speaker: Challenge.

Siguro 'yong ano po. Even in communication, he's slowly learning even our language eh. Although, for me, probably learning their language. Although, it wasn't really a big factor.

Interviewer: You mean the mother tongue, something like that?

Speaker: Yes, but it's not really a big factor, kasi when I hang out with their family and friends, with his family and friends, they speak naman po in Filipino. So, not much, but I would love to understand also some of the things that I talk about.

Interviewer: Right. If I may ask, what is his native language or mother tongue?

Speaker: [Language].

Interviewer: [Language]. Ah so that's why, there's really some kind of difference in the way, in the language.

Speaker: Although, some of the words, some of their words are also similar in [Ethnicity].

Interviewer: Uh huh, yeah.

Speaker: We usually joke about it on how the [Ethnicity] jokes or the [Ethnicity] jokes, how the people from [Language] were washed out, or something like that.

Interviewer: Right, yes, I think I've heard about that joke as well.

Interviewer: So, based on what you shared, there's no major fight. Only, and as you said, the description is more like tampuhan. Okay. And it doesn't really last that long. And if there's one thing, perhaps that might challenge, as you said no, something that could be a challenge would be some kind of language barrier sometimes. But as you said, he's also trying to learn the language and in the same way, I also appreciate the idea that of course, when he is with his family or friends, they actually use the Filipino language.

Interviewer: So just to probe a little bit on relationship challenges, when you said tampuhan earlier, tampuhan. Can you give me like a little example, just to make it more concrete, the basis of this tampuhan?

Speaker: Usually, I'm more outgoing than him. So, and I'm more of a go-getter. So when it comes to handling some [field] or even volunteering at church or simply trying to meet with some people or some friends, and he's more of a homebody, sometimes he gets tired of me always going out and trying to pull him in to going out. He just wants to stay at home. So, that's our tampuhan at times. When I want to bring him, and he doesn't want to. And he's my driver, so it would be convenient for me to go on these meetings or some activities, but he would rather stay at home. So, for me, sometimes it pushes our tampus, it turns into arguments, and then after that, I'm, he's quite blessed because I'm forgetful. So, sometimes I forget that we're having a fight. So when I get back, I share my frustrations or everything that had happened in my day. And then I remember that, "oh wait, we're fighting". Until, "okay, fine, it's okay, it's fine na".

Interviewer: Okay, I think I get what you're saying. So sometimes, yeah, maybe because after some time you realize, it's not really a big fight after all, but I guess that's because as you said, it's tampuhan, and not a major fight. So in relation to this tampuhan, you actually partly mentioned it already. So, in resolving the tampuhan, what do you think was the mechanism that you know resolves it immediately in a way because you said, 'di nga nagtatagal naman. So, how do you actually resolve it? Aside from what you said, and you forget that you're actually nagtatampo or nagkatampus. But were there other mechanisms on how you resolve this tampuhan?

Speaker: Hmm, what I've observed as well with him, he seldom say sorry. And for us to resolve it, is usually after me forgetting it and him. I don't think if, I don't know if he forgets that we're having a tampuhan, pero, after the silent treatment, he talks to me and then gives me something that I want, usually, it's food. And then he doesn't say the word "sorry", but he shows it. Or often then, it should be. So, I think that's how he says he's sorry and then sometimes I teach him how to say sorry after we've talked about it. So, the first thing he'll do is do something, and afterwards we talk about it. And we joke about it even after a few days. So, I think that's how we resolve it.

Interviewer: So, although not in words, but more on action, something like that. And then from there, parang the tension is, parang nawawala na yung tension, and then that's a time that you said, maybe that's a time that you actually can talk about it more and even joke about it.

Okay, right. So, when you said do something, he would do something that's, how would you say it? Do something like, I think your example earlier was do something like buy you something like food that you like. Is that the one you're referring to?

Speaker: Or on giving me food or cooking me food. Until he calls you to eat.

Interviewer: Okay.

Speaker: Fortunately, he cooks well. So...

Interviewer: So, match sa ano...

Speaker: Opo, or even in chores, like he'll be doing my chore. And then 'yon, that's how he says sorry.

Interviewer: Okay, okay. Right. So, thank you for that.

Now, aside from what you said, are there other ways by which you maintain your relationship? So like, how do you, you said, I suppose, there's based on the answer as well, there's high satisfaction in the relationship. But, how do you maintain it? How do you maintain the relationship?

Speaker: To be honest, nothing to Christian, but it's really, I think, from God as well. Kasi we usually, during the pandemic, with me and my family, of course, we're closed down in the house or I think it was more than [1-5] year. So, what we did is we had this daily devotion where actually he wasn't totally a Christian yet during those times. So, I think it was the time that he opened up to Jesus and then that's when we started having this daily devotion, which until now it's still going on. And then what happened in our daily devotion po kasi is, of course, we read the Gospels, we read the Bible, and then we share each other's thoughts and then discoveries about it. So, the everyday that we do that, it became, also ano with him, normal with him.

Speaker: The communication became better and then we maintained it all throughout until now. So, just because of that daily devotion, I think the communication got better and we got more comfortable. Because, before being married we were in a long-distance relationship, our communication usually was through just chats or video calls. When he got here in Baguio, he started working here and at first, it was quite awkward kasi I see him na parang everyday, because my parents allowed him to stay with us but in a separate room, he's like a tenant or something. So, it was weird for me having him there every day unlike when we were in a long-distance relationship where we just get to talk to each other after work and just for a few hours, one or two hours, sometimes not even. And we're not the clingy couple who texts each other every second or every meal. We just really have the communication at night, probably one to two hours, and sometimes if I'm busy or if he's busy, he has activities, we don't talk on that day. So, having that daily devotion for us, it improved our communication which we maintain until now. So, I think having just the time to talk about some things or even have that devotion with each other, quite helped us a lot and helped maintain the relationship, and kept us on our feet. Kasi syempre, while reading the Bible, you'll be like you'll be also judging yourself for what you've been doing. So, I think that's it.

Interviewer: Okay, sige. Thank you for that. All right. So, I think I fully understand yung context na yun from long distance and of course that part where it became a mechanism by which we were really able to communicate on a regular basis, and how you also maintain this in the relationship. Can you hear me clearly?

Speaker: Yes po.

Interviewer: Am I clear? I did not check my audio earlier when we started. So, I'm wondering if you can hear me clearly. Right. Now moving on. Given this relationship, would you say that this relationship is good for you and why?

Speaker: I think it's good for me.

Interviewer: All right. And the question is when you say good for you, actually maybe I can mention this, that when we say that the relationship is good for you, we're also looking into how this relationship is able to let you achieve your goals on a day-to-day basis. So kumbaga, yung functioning mo or functioning ng husband mo kumbaga it's because of the relationship, yung daily goals ninyo. So in that sense, so you said yes. So, given that additional notion of what is good for you, would you still say that this relationship is good for you?

Speaker: Oh yes po.

Interviewer: And could you elaborate on the reasons why?

Speaker: Uh okay. Like what I've mentioned earlier, the qualities of having a good relationship which are those four.

Interviewer: Yes, okay.

Speaker: Giving me that and me as much as I can if give him that, um, our bond becomes stronger and then it, what's also good about it is we don't restrict each other in terms of what we, the other things that we want to do. So, having that support from another person who we are married to is I think really good for me. And since we do that to each other, we say things that we want to do and him backing me up and me backing him up whatever he wants to do.

Interviewer: Okay.

Speaker: So, that bondage makes it better, and actually, it's the partnership that we have as well is quite good and like, unlike, of course, the previous relationships, that I've had in comparison also to other relationships that I see and even one of my friends and one of my friends told me that it's good that you're still having that you still have a strong relationship because those with our age mates who are already married she had heard already multiple, um, cheating rumors and even multiple fights that had gone for so long, and she was quite surprised that for us, we are there to support each other and it's actually good for each other. That's why I think we had less conflicts and we're just so comfortable I think with each other. It's good for us.

Interviewer: Right. Okay. So there's the support no? Parang ganoon and then you said wala go yung being comfortable with each other. I have another topic here, it's on identity. Did this relationship change you in, if yes, if yes or no or, kindly explain?

Speaker: Yes. But, not totally, not like a total 180.

Interviewer: Change, yeah.

Speaker: Since, I met him when I was [20-25], yeah, I think he helped me mature. So I changed, I hope for the better, and yeah that's how I think he changed me as well

Interviewer: When you say you become more mature, what could be your indicators for this sense of maturity?

Speaker: Because, when I was younger, I was not that of a risk taker as I am now. Although, it can be a good or bad thing. But, I became a risk taker, in a sense that in the things that I do, I know I can rely on him. So, since he supports me in everything that I do, it pushed me more to become a risk taker. He says he supports me, so I have someone behind my back, unlike when I was just alone and I would take on some situations or I would take some deals that are, that brings me anxiety, because I don't know what would happen if this doesn't work out. So, he kinda is also my safety blanket, so, that's why I became quite more riskier in the things that I do. But, he knows that I love doing those things. So, meaning those things like I go into like partnerships or businesses or some interests that I do. So, since he supports everything even my church activities at times, so, it made me more mature in a way that, um I learned a lot. I couldn't itemize the one thing but I really learned a lot and I became, he became my safety blanket, and that's why I can't totally say, I'm in the middle of this na being a risk taker and being, um, more aware or more responsible of the things that I decide on. So, I'm quite in the middle. I risk being, having a deal that's bigger, at the same time, being cautious because I have responsibilities that I should also be aware of. So, it's kind of mix and mix, but the maturity level that I had now, that I had before, as compared to now is quite different. So, I think 'yon po.

Interviewer: Mas in a way, an instrument to that increasing maturity, and okay. So, in a way in terms of identity, there's still something that has changed about you but as you said, not a drastic change from who you were before. Is that correct?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Yeah, okay. So, how about now let's reverse the situation, how about your husband? Did he change during the relationship? Did you see any change because of, for you, you said, you became more mature and he was a major, he has played a major role on that, like if I'm sorry kasi may mga parts na hindi ako sure kung tama 'yong dinig ko. Did you mention na yung idea ng security blanket? am I correct?

Speaker: Yes.

Interviewer: Yes, okay. So, yun 'no? Parang malabo kasi yung part ng security. So, I want to make sure that that's the one I heard. Okay now as for your husband, do you think bago rin ba siya? Was he, you know, the same before the relationship as he is now or was there something different about him that happened because of the relationship?

Speaker: Uh, he didn't drastically change then po. Parang it became also the same for him, I think. He became more adventurous, although he was adventurous, but my personality compared to his him being a homebody and me being outgoing. He became even adventurous and even curious also, since, I'm into going out there, so he became open to it. And the change to his personality, actually, there's no change in his personality, he stayed the same. I remember him quoting like, I mean, I remembered him saying this phrase where I've seen some people when they get married or when they get into a relationship, um, even their, the way they change, I mean the way they dress to change because it's somehow controlled by the partner. And then I told him na "buti ikaw hindi mo ako inaano", kasi some are very conservative, they don't want, like, their girlfriends showing half of their arms, something like that. Like, a little bit of their chests, something like that. But, as for him, he told me that "eh ganyan na kita na nakilala eh".

“Alangan naman... saka sakto lang naman”. I mean, “okay lang naman, okay ka lang naman manamit”. For some kasi, it's extreme.

Interviewer: Yeah, ibabago talaga yung iba.

Speaker: Ibabago, kahit ‘yong pakikipag-meet sa friends every time we have a get together with my friends, he would go sometimes he won't. But, he respects the part that, that's who I am and then that's how he met me. So, he wouldn't change anything, because ‘yon yung nagustuhan niyang traits.

Interviewer: And this goes, uh, this is actually almost the same for him. So, he did not really change much about his personality, but you mentioned that somehow he became more open to this more adventurous side. Because, ‘yon nga, given that you were a bit more outgoing than him. Is that correct?

Speaker: Yes

Interviewer: Okay so, thank you for that. Now, the next part is on how safe you feel in the relationship. So, do you feel safe in the relationship and why do you say so?

Speaker: Ah yes po. Parang ‘yong na-mention ko earlier na he became my safe blanket. So, even if I'm doing something risky. Literally, mga jumping off a cliff gano’n, pero ‘yong may tubig naman po sa ano.

Interviewer: So, literally jumping off, ‘yun ‘yon.

Speaker: Literally jumping off ng mga falls gano’n. So siya, he doesn't do it, pero, alam kong nando’n siya magka-catch sa bottom.

Interviewer: Oh okay.

Speaker: ‘Yong literal pong talagang nando’n po siya sa baba, hindi nya gagawin po yun, but nando’n siya sa baba, nagaantay kung may mangyayari. Pero since gusto ko kasing gawin, nasa bucket list ko po.

Interviewer: Oo, he will allow you, and then he'll be there to catch you and wait for you.

Speaker: Babantayan po what would happen, like that. Nando’n pa rin po yung support, but at the same time, nando’n din siya sa baba

Interviewer: All right, so anything else you'd like to say about this about the feeling of safety in the relationship?

Speaker: Um, if you have that person who's like your safe blanket or your security, you wouldn't be scared to do some things that you think isn't possible. Syempre the same that, actually, even it's what I have been telling him na if you have God and to be honest if you're not afraid to die because you know where you're going already, so for us, tell him, I've told him that, even confronting some people or even doing some challenges won't be that hard if we have a safe blanket. And for me, it's, of course, the Lord and, at the same time, it's him. I think I hope that he feels the same, and not, and um, won't grow tired when a lot of this like adventurous things happen, but that's what I feel with him.

Interviewer: All right, so thank you for qualifying what you mean by that feeling of safety with your husband. Now I will share screen, because your answer will depend on a scale. So, let me just show you, okay here, alright can you see it? Dito muna tayo sa first two slides. Okay, slideshow ko nga, there. So, this

is one of the first two questions. So, um, from a scale of one to nine, which is not at all true to completely true. What would your answer be from this question?

Interviewer: My partner usually really listens to me. So, from one, not at all true, to nine, completely true.

Speaker: I'm gonna go with eight

Interviewer: Eight, right. So, let's move on to the next item first before I ask for some follow-up questions. so this is the second item.

Interviewer: My partner usually is responsive to my needs which is from one to nine again. But, of course, one is not at all true and nine is completely true

Speaker: I would go with nine.

Interviewer: Right, nine. Okay. Now, going back to the previous slide I'll ask a follow-up question. Tama ba ito 'yong isa? Tama. Right, so um, for this question you answered eight. Now, can you qualify why you answered eight for item one?

Speaker: I wouldn't say it's completely true, because sometimes when I'm asking him about, tell him some of my stories, he either forgets or wasn't really listening in the middle of my stories. Usually, I really take a long time telling my stories, because I want to give him the full context of it.

Interviewer: Right, right.

Speaker: But, majority of the time, he listens.

Interviewer: So, kaya nando'n siya sa pagitan ng, kumbaga, a little bellow lang ng completely true. Pero, hindi naman siya number seven. So, if I will just probe a little, why not, very true pa rin naman 'yong seven. But, why not seven, and instead, you answered eight?

Speaker: Kasi po, he remembers a lot of what I've said versus me remembering the things that he has said since 'yon nga po, mas forgetful ako, so bibigyan ako po siya ng additional points, kaya mas mataas.

Interviewer: Now, that same question also, I would like to ask for this item. For this, you answered nine. So, can you qualify why you answered nine for this item? Why not eight for example, which is a bit lower and just like your answer previously? Can you elaborate on that?

Speaker: Responsive, in a way na, hindi naman po binibigay lahat. Although, responsive siya na hindi nga ibigay, so nag-respond naman po siya na "hindi mo 'yan kailangan", ganun siya or "needs ko". Pero, responsive naman po siya, ta's na identify niya if I need it or not, or if he can tell me, if he can actually tell me that, I want that, just by looking at me looking at something.

Interviewer: Halimbawa, sa ano yan, sa shopping? Ganyan mag-sshop kayo or something?

Speaker: Mga gano'n, 'yong tipong 'pag nakita niyang may tinitignan ako, kahit multiple items siya, kinakantsawan niya ako na "gusto mo 'yan no?". At least, responsive siya. Pero, ano naman po, pagdating sa needs ko, yung alam niyang kailangan, ano naman po, binibigay naman niya. Tapos, pinagbibigyan niya rin po kung minsan at times, yung mga wants ko lang po. I'm not really high maintenance, pero he knows

what I need and he's responsive naman po to follow those things, as long as he can provide it, 'yon po yung binibigay niya.

Interviewer: So, I'll stop sharing for a bit, and then, actually, malapit na tayong matapos. Pasensya na, ang dami rin kasi tong scripts ko. So, the next part is a bit more sensitive, part of that is you mentioned earlier something about being romantic and that being romantic is not always dependent on physical or touching. So, I have to ask this question, but I hope you don't mind. But, if you do mind, feel free to say if this is too sensitive for you to share. But, I also wanted to know more about your physical intimacy as a couple. It's just one question. Actually, two, but as a follow-up yung isa. So, for example in terms of physical intimacy, particularly, of course, sex, which is a part of, in a husband-wife relationship as well. So, how would you describe it? For example level of satisfaction as well and in terms of, let's say, frequency or something like that. So, feel free to talk about it in a way that you're comfortable talking about.

Speaker: So, in the level po of physical intimacy?

Interviewer: Physical intimacy, in general, we cannot deny also the importance of sex in the relationship of, as husband and wife.

Speaker: For our intimacy, I would say I'm very satisfied naman po. So, in terms of sex, we do it frequently, more frequent than the average couple, I guess. So, in terms of like touching or cuddling, we do it quite a lot, because, I think I'm more clingy than him, which I think he likes a lot. So, in terms of cuddling and even sex, it's more than what I've usually heard with my friends who are married or even in a relationship. So, I think they say they would be envious at the same time if I told them.

Interviewer: Wow, that's good to know, in a way. But, of course, thank you for sharing that and it seems like well you said you're satisfied and that's actually the follow up question. So, anything else that you'd like to include regarding this part of your relationship?

Speaker: Although, I want to add is that despite having the physical activities that we have now, I'm already expecting a decline in the future, because naintindihan ko na our bodies wouldn't be the same as before. I mean even comparing with how we are physically before, as compared to now, syempre po mas extreme when you were younger. But, as you grow older, parang with our age now, it's still more than the average, as compared to those around us. But, I'm already understanding, or I'm already preparing myself on how this would probably decline as years go by. So, parang vina-value ko rin po talaga yung communication and yung partnership, kasi I know that in the future yung physical din po talaga is mawawala or mababawasan. Ay, hindi naman sa mawawala, mababawasan lang po, not like as 'yong before.

Interviewer: Thank you for that. So, in a way, parang you have this more realistic understanding of physical intimacy in general, and how important the more psychological part of intimacy, which as you said, importance of communication and the partnership. Now, I have one more slide to show you. So, thank you. This is the one, let me see ko ma-share. This is the same slide, the same file, pero I'll be asking you a more general question. Actually, this is the one I sent earlier sa email, but meron akong follow-up question for this this one. So first is to ask you, walang rating muna, but you can see na meron ding differences, of course, in the gradation.

Speaker: Okay, for this one, completely satisfied.

Interviewer: Completely satisfied. Now, since you answered completely satisfied, I'll just go to another slide. Right, teka lang baka magkamali ako. This one, so how would you rate your satisfaction with your relationship? So from a scale of zero to ten. Okay, so, of course, zero being not at all satisfied, and ten is completely satisfied. How would you rate your satisfaction with the relationship in numerical value this time?

Speaker: I would say ten.

Interviewer: Right, ten, okay.

Now, of course, I want to probe, on your answer, why did you answer this particular response which is 10? Again, why not 9 for example?

Speaker: For me, hindi ko po inaano ha. I'm not just because for an interview or for these questions na I'm putting my husband on a pedestal or something, or I'm putting a relationship in a pedestal. But, I've rated 10, because po, since we, being an outgoing person in having a lot of friends to talk to, na habang wala pa po kaming anak, I would say completely satisfied, in comparison to the relationships I've been hearing with my friends and even colleagues. So, masasabi ko, masasabi ko "thank you, Lord", syempre na somehow we're still comfortable with each other, and I'm not really sugarcoating yung hindi po talaga kami nag-away. Kasi, it's true, we haven't had that big fight, where we go to our family para magsumbong, it never went to those kinds of level. Kaya, I would say ten, as compared syempre to the people around me on how "thank God, he's my partner, he's my husband", and I hope he does this, he would say the same, but for me listening to the relationships now, talagang completely satisfied.

Interviewer: Thank you for that. Because, of course, I'm not here to, of course, evaluate anything. I'm here to, of course, listen to your story and later this will be documented in part of a bigger study as I've said also in the email na we're also doing this in other countries. So, we're now close to wrapping up, and I would just like to summarize what we have conversed about in the past a little over a little over an hour I think, but, so let me just go through my notes, and then tell me if there's anything that I misquoted or anything that I did not get right so that you can of course clarify.

Interviewer: So, first is, of course, when you talked about the love story you started. Mainly, it was you met in your work and it was there that because you had opportunity to work together, that was the opportunity where you actually met each other and where the relationship, in a way, developed. But, you also mentioned that it initially started really as friendship and then it developed from there. And then, in terms of relationship quality, you mentioned that this relationship, sabihin na nating high quality. There is a common theme that you are mentioning here and that is, the emotional availability of your partner. You qualified what you meant by being emotionally available, like for example, you go on dates more often, hanging out, you share stories and conversations, and there's also opportunities for the both of you to open up. And this is, of course, you mentioned this in relation to when you compare it to other relationships that you know.

Interviewer: Also, aside from those things that you mentioned, aside from being emotionally, being emotionally available rather, as an indicator of a high-quality relationship, you also mentioned other indicators such as the importance of support, encouragement, and partnership. You also mentioned the importance of good communication, loyalty, and the top of the list is, of course, with respect to your Christian faith, is of course, the presence of God in your relationship. As for the conceptualization of love,

one key point or the key phrase that you mentioned is the love as sacrificial, love as a sacrificial kind of love, and you noted that of course, in love there is somehow understanding certain things are given up such as time, opportunities, but knowing that this love is worth it, the partner, you and your partner are ready to somehow sacrifice certain things for you to sustain the love. And you did mention that love which is important, can be seen in the small things in actions just like what you said earlier, the actions of your partner.

Interviewer: Now, in terms of your relationships, you mentioned that there are no big fights really and the term used was more on *tampuhan*. You did say that language barrier might be a factor in the relationship, but it's not really, I think it was not really mentioned as a big, a big concern, but maybe just a little challenge. You also mentioned that *tampuhan*, maybe coming from the idea that you have of course differences, in terms of let's say, personalities. Like for example, one being more outgoing and that's you, and one being more a homebody. In this *tampuhan*, you mentioned that the way that you resolve this *tampuhan* is that maybe, not in the saying sorry, but doing something for the partner in order to re-establish, *kumbaga*, the balance in the relationship to dissipate the tension. Daily devotions were also mentioned as one of your mechanisms for maintaining the relationship, you mentioned that it made the communication between the two of you better.

Interviewer: In terms of your, you mentioned that the relationship is good for you, because it is in this relationship that you find support and you feel comfortable in this relationship. There's also, you became mature, also in the process of having this relationship. There was not really a major change for both of you, but there were you know, openness, to certain, *sabihin na nating ikaw halimbawa*, you became more mature, as a risk taker, and *siya naman yung partner mo yung husband mo* became more open also to adventures and was there to support you.

Interviewer: As for relationship safety, you said that your husband is your safety blanket. He's the source of your safety and with respect to the items I mentioned you answered eight for your partner being, the question was on, as your partner being able to listen to you you answered eight for that. And your partner being responsive to your needs, you answered nine.

Interviewer: As for the physical intimacy and sex, you mentioned that *mataas naman yung iyong satisfaction*, but at the same time you said that perhaps comparing it to other married couples, the sex is probably more frequent compared to other couples. But, you also mentioned that you're also somehow realistic enough to see that maybe this part of your relationship might also decline as you also grow older. In general, you are completely satisfied with the relationship, not an exaggeration definitely, but you said that the qualities that you mentioned earlier support this idea that the relationship really makes you fully satisfied about it. Like, *yung mga na-mention mo na emotionally available and God being the center of the relationship*, and so on.

Interviewer: So is there anything else? So, that's a quick wrap-up, *para lang ma-picture natin yung na share mo sa akin ngayong hapon*. So, do you have anything else that you'd like to add?

Speaker: Maybe ano po. I would add that in our relationship, pride really doesn't, doesn't need to be present. *Parang we don't value pride as much as compared with the other couples that we've been listening to where that level of pride should be turned down or the both of us being a couple, also matured in a way that we both get to humble ourselves. By humbling ourselves, we usually see the other side of the picture. So, after having that conversation of why I'm mad about him about this thing or he's mad*

about me about this thing, coming to a conclusion where we both humble ourselves and we get to understand more of each other, where it became more easier to be in that relationship. So, we usually put down our pride when we get to have these conversations, although these conversations usually take just a short time, because I think we both know that it wouldn't help us both if we just keep our pride up.

Interviewer: So, thank you for sharing that last point. So, I think that was a point that was not really emphasized earlier, but the importance of humbling ourselves, and the idea that pride in relationships will not really do the relationship any good. Instead of making the relationship, *sabi na natin*, run more smoothly, the pride will add tension to the relationship. So, that's actually the last question.

Interviewer: But, before we go I'd like to talk to you about again, the handling of the data. As a research project, of course, we want to reiterate that we want to be ethically transparent as possible. So, we want to know which data sharing option you're most comfortable with, so that's in the consent form, but we can also note that in the recording now. So, option one is that transcript portions can be shared, none of which can be identified to you, so that the identified transcript can be read by other researchers. So actually, if you notice sa consent form, *meron kasi doong portal ko saan nalo-load lahat ng transcriptions* and that's part of being transparent as a researcher, so that other people can scrutinize the data. But, definitely *walang identity 'yon* and all other things that might be more personal na information will be redacted. Like, *halimbawa* when you mention something about Baguio or Ibaloi, so that's a very specific term. So, those should be redacted in the transcription. Okay, so that's option one.

Interviewer: Option two, *kasi yung option one portions lang*, option two is, if the other option is that the whole transcript like the way we talk now will be shared that the whole transcript can be shared. But, of course, removed of sensitive identifying details, so it will be anonymized, so it will be in this option, there's minimal chance *parin* that someone who knows you well can piece together the details in the transcript and narrow down who among their colleagues they believe it is. So, no sensitive information will be shared. So, like the names of, *kayo as participants*, *hindi ko na 'yan actually isasama sa recording*. So, I'll just upload the recording and if you notice, I never call you by your name, my name lang, when I introduce myself. But, I did not ask you to introduce yourself anymore, so *kumbaga*, basically the entire transcription can be will be made available na *do'n sa ating data sharing portal*, and then, so of the two options, *alin ng mas comfortable ka is it option one or option two?*

Speaker: Probably option two. I'm fine with it.

Interviewer: Okay, *sige*. Thank you so much. Again, thank you for participating in this study. Again, I also want to, I mentioned this already, but we were doing this in the Philippines, in Brazil, in Turkey, as well as in France, and in the US. So, in case, although I'm already nearing my quota *naman na sa participants*. But in case you know people who can be recommended as couples as well, or nominators just like *si Vili(?)* who nominated you, if you can recommend them as well, then we will get in touch with you. Also later, I will send you an email, where there's a link for a survey, of course, this is totally *kumbaga*, it's voluntary *pa din*, I'll send to you *yung details no'n* and if there's any question that you might have, *mayro'n din namang contact person doon*, aside from myself, but you can always reach out to me *kung meron ka mong certain concerns or questions pa about the study*. Of course, there's also an opportunity to ask for the results of the study once it's done, *pero not soon yet, pero baka maybe by next year, made available na 'yong results of the study*. And of course, if you want to find out more about the results, we can share them with you, although *hindi ako yung lead person dito syempre*, *si Miguel Silan* will be in charge of the entire project. So, that's basically it, so thank you. Thank you so much, really, I'm grateful that you were

recommended by [Name] and I hope matapos namin 'yong kay, sa iyong husband later. Okay, but we can, we can end this session now, so thank you so much. Just feel free to communicate with me if you need anything

Speaker: Okay po, okay po, thank you.

Interviewer: Sa next nalang na link, para ma-stop ko na ito. All alright, thank you.

Speaker: Bye, nice meeting you. Thank you.